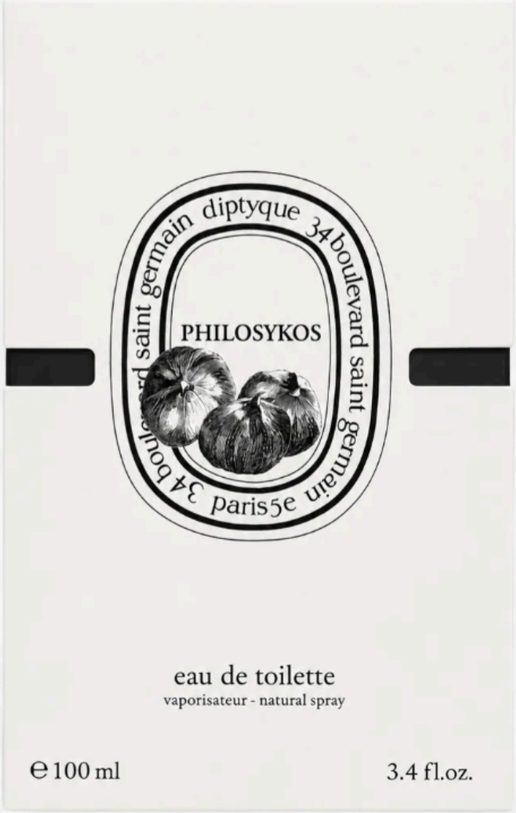
DIPTYQUE EAU DE TOILETTE

PHILOSYKOS

PACKAGING ANALYSIS

BELLA LIU
CONSUMER PSYCHOLOGY
OCTOBER 26, 2026









DIPTYQUE

Diptyque is a Parisian luxury fragrance house founded by three artists. Founded in 1961, it started with scented candles and later expanded into perfumes and home decor. Inspired by nature, travel, and art, Diptyque is known for its iconic oval labels and hand-drawn, story-driven designs(Parfums Eau Eau).



PHILOSYKOS

- “Fig leaves, Fig tree sap, Fig tree wood, Black pepper”
- “The freshness of the leaves, the milky flavour of the fruit, the density of the white wood. Philosykos eau de toilette is an ode to the entire fig tree.”
- “A fragrance that feels like a memory – of crossing a wild grove under the blazing Greek sun. The tale of a summer spent at Mount Pelion, told now in perfume(Diptyque).”

GOAL&TARGET AUDIENCE



1

Where to find it

Diptyque boutiques, diptyque official website, and luxury department stores such as Nordstrom.

2

Goal

Tell a story about a summer under the fig trees of Greece rather than simply describing how the fragrance smells.

3

Target audience

Urban, middle class or upper-middle class young professionals who want a distinctive, artistic fragrance; prefer niche and quiet luxury.

4

Why this audience

The premium price, selective retail channels, and the art-driven packaging attract consumers who can afford and appreciate artistic products.

AUDIENCE DEMOGRAPHICS

- Gender: primarily women, but also appeals to men and people who prefer gender-neutral scents.
- Age: young to middle-aged adults, mainly between 23-40
- Location: urban areas, major cities such as NYC, Boston, LA, London, and Paris.
- Income levels: primarily upper-middle-class consumers, as well as aspirational consumers who see a Diptyque perfume as a small luxury and a way to treat themselves.
- Education & occupation: college-educated, working in fields such as fashion, editing, design, and literature.
- Secondary audience: gift buyers(looking for a luxury present for work partners, parents, or friends).



AUDIENCE PSYCHOGRAPHICS

1

Interests

- Travel&culture: especially to Europe and the Mediterranean, exploring local culture and lifestyle.
- Art&design: art galleries and exhibitions, architecture, literature.
- Self-care: willing to spend money and time on rituals that make them feel refreshed.

2

Values

- Individuality and self-expression
- Craftsmanship
- Storytelling
- Sensory experiences

3

Dreams

- Personally: a refined personal style and a signature scent that represents who they are.
- Socially: be seen as someone with good taste and uniqueness.
- Lifestyle: balance life with cultural, aesthetic, and memorable experiences.

AUDIENCE PSYCHOGRAPHICS

4

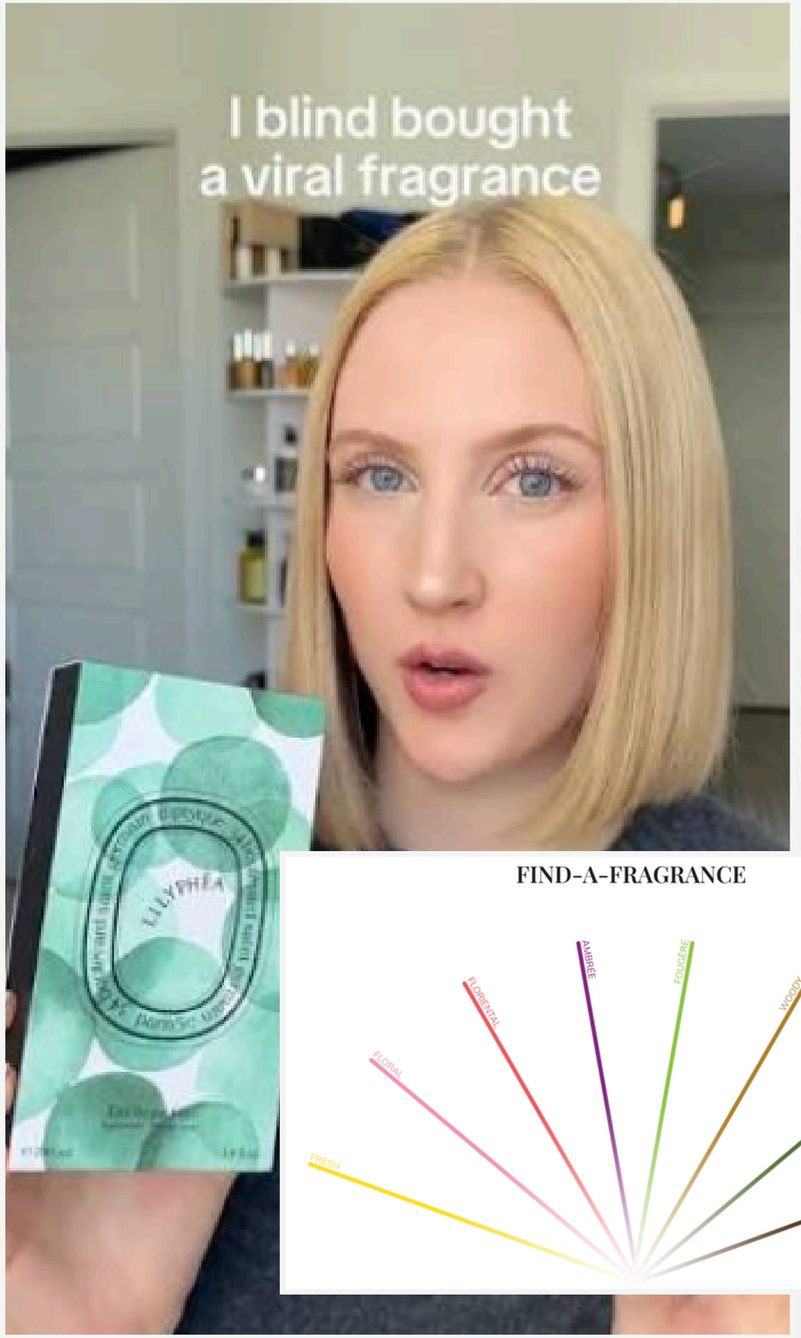
Potential fears

- Blend in: smelling like everyone else or blindly following what's trendy that does not reflect their personality.
- Losing work-life balance or a sense of self.

5

Uncertainties

- Product-wise: Is the quality or the scent worth the price? Is the fig scent unique?
- Social image-wise: does this fragrance fit the image I want to present or my taste? How will others perceive me and recognize the scent?



REACHING AUDIENCES

Beauty creators on Tiktok&Instagram

Concept: Brand encoding problem(Intriligator, Lect 13, p.26)
Importance: An ad fails if viewers cannot link it to the brand, although it might be memorable.
Application: The influencer needs to show the label within the first second and repeat it several times throughout the video.



The perfume society(website)

Concept: consideration set(Intriligator, Lect 12, p.20)
Importance: When consumers are new to a category, they mostly rely on social proof and others' views.
Application: Positive reviews on the Perfume Society website can help Philosykos get into the consideration set of consumers who are new to niche perfumes.
Keywords target consumers might search for: "niche perfume", "fresh unisex fragrance", "Diptyque fig scent"...

REACHING AUDIENCES



In-store ambience

Concept: scent congruence(Intriligator, Lect 3, p.30)
Importance: A scent that matches the product being sold is more effective than one that is simply pleasant.
Application: having sales associates wear Philosykos, lightly misting it around the counter, or placing a fig-scented diffuser nearby to fill the space with a matching scent and reinforce the fig story.

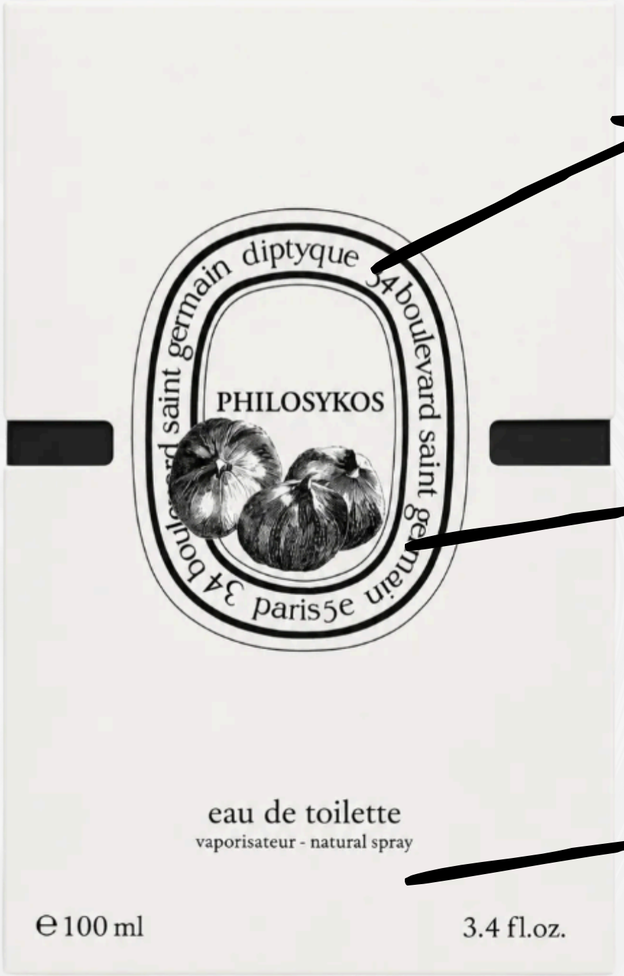
REACHING AUDIENCES



For secondary consumers: gifting

Concept: Deal breakers(non-compensatory rules)(Intriligator, Lect 12, p.37)
Importance: If a product fails one key cutoff, such as price. it is eliminated no matter how good its other features are.
Application: Smaller sizes let Philosykos pass a price cutoff instead of being eliminated early.

CONTENT ANALYSIS



Brand heritage in the circular text: the address “34 boulevard Saint Germain, Paris 5e” wraps around the label, referencing Diptyque’s first boutique, though this may confuse most consumers.

Fig illustration: Both the box and the bottle feature three figs in a detailed, engraving-style drawing, making the scent visible and helping consumers imagine the smell before trying it.

Functional info: the box includes practical details that the bottle leaves out, such as what the product is and the volume in both ml and fl.oz. It only adds important details so that the design is still clean and artistic.



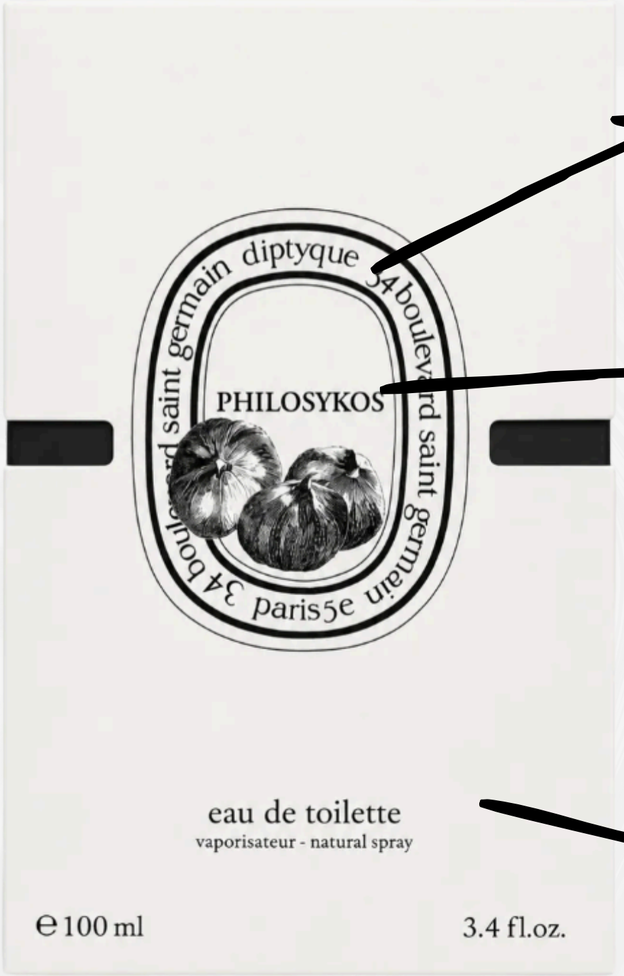
CONTENT ANALYSIS



Hidden drawing on the back: the back label shows a landscape with a starry sky, the sea, a stone fountain, and lush trees, which can be seen through the glass from the front. This scene tells the story behind the product without using any text.

What's missing: The product name "PHILOSYKOS" comes from Greek, so I assume most consumers may not know what it means. However, neither the box nor the bottle translates the name or explains in English that it is a fig scent, and it includes no scent notes. Although the fig illustrations can be seen as a visual hint, consumers still have to guess what the perfume smells like.

PRESENTATIONAL ANALYSIS



Reversed colors: the box uses black lines on a white background, while the bottle label uses white on black, which creates consistency while making the bottle feel like a reveal when consumers take it out of the box.

Texts: The product name is written in capital letters, which looks classic and literary; only Diptyque at the top and Paris at the bottom stand out, while the rest of the text requires consumers to rotate the bottle. Also, since there are no dividers between words, it is confusing where to start reading.

White space: the large amount of space communicates restraint, giving the packaging a high-end look.



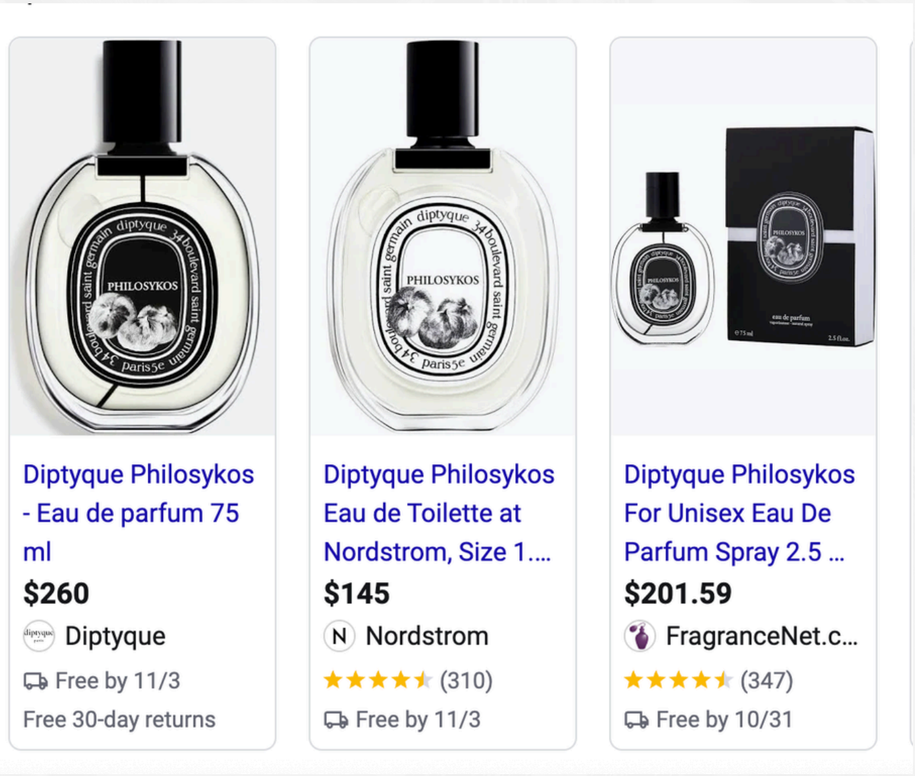
PRESENTATIONAL ANALYSIS



Minimalist design: The bottle has a plain black cap with no logo or decoration and a simple, regular oval body made of clear glass, which makes the two labels the only focus of the bottle. The minimalist decoration also signals quiet luxury, suggesting that the brand wants to keep it low-key and confident enough not to rely on flashy details.

Layered depth: the clear glass makes the front and back labels appear layered on top of each other, which makes the bottle feel like a piece of art and echoes each other.

PRESENTATIONAL ANALYSIS



Online presentation: In Google shopping results, almost every listing shows only the front of the bottle on a white background, while the box rarely appears among the results. The black label and the fig illustration still stand out clearly. However, the circular text becomes too small to read, and the drawing on the back is never shown, so the story behind the scent is lost.

Impression: Consistent with its goal of telling a story, the packaging leaves the consumers feeling that they are enjoying a piece of art and a memory, not just a perfume.

How successful is the artifact in general?

The packaging succeeds in building an artistic, high-end brand image and telling the Greek summer story through visuals, which fits the goal of storytelling. However, it is less successful at helping consumers understand the name and the scent, which may stop them from buying without trying it in-store first.

RECOMMENDATIONS

1

Improve the readability

Add dividers, such as dots, between “Diptyque”, “34 Boulevard Saint Germain”, and “Paris”, which could show consumers where to start reading. In this way, the circular design can still be kept while making the brand’s heritage easier to notice.

2

Translate the name

Add a short line such as “Philosykos: friend of the fig tree” and a small scent map listing the notes on the front of the box, which could be helpful for consumers to acquire the information they need without affecting the minimalist design of the bottle.

3

Show the hidden drawing

The drawing on the back of the bottle is the most unique part of the design, but consumers can only see it when they open the box or turn the bottle around. Printing the drawing on the side of the box or the back would let the consumers discover the story behind the scent earlier and may make it become more attractive to certain consumers.

DATA COLLECTION

Quantitative data:

- Research question: How does consumers' knowledge of the story behind the product and its scent affect their purchase intention?
- Method: Online survey experiment. ~100 perfume buyers aged 23-40. All of them are randomly shown one of the three box designs: 1. the original; 2. with the translated name and a scent map; 3. with the landscape drawing printed on the side or the back of the box and a short line about the Greek summer story.
- Measurement: Purchase intention rated from 1 to 7, along with perceived luxury, to check that the added info does not make the packaging feel less high-end.
- Analysis: Compare the average purchase intention of three groups. If knowing the scent or the story increases purchase intention, then Diptyque should add that info to the box.

DATA COLLECTION

Qualitative data:

- Research question: How do consumers understand the packaging, and what information do they feel is missing when deciding whether to buy?
- Methods:

1. In-store observation: Watch whether customers turn the bottle and take a close look at it, or try to read the circular text.
2. Interviews: Ask 10 customers what they think the name and the illustration mean, and if they hesitate to buy, what's the reason behind that.

- Purpose: Whether consumers understand the story and scent from the packaging alone, and what missing information makes them hesitate.
- Analysis: Group the findings into patterns to decide which info Diptyque should add to the packaging.

STORYBOARD BRIDGET'S JOURNEY



Bridget is a 23-year-old recent graduate in Fine Arts and European Literature, living in Boston. She loves art and literature, pursues individuality and avoids mainstream trends, and sees a Diptyque perfume as a small luxury to treat herself.

1. Need: After a graduation trip to Greece, she wants a signature scent as a gift to herself for starting a new chapter.
2. Search: She watched an Instagram reel showing a Diptyque perfume that "smells like a fig tree". She then searches for it on the Perfume Society website.
3. Consideration set: Miss Dior, Le Labo Santal 33, and Diptyque Philosykos
4. Decision rules: conjunctive: The perfume must be under $200, have a fresh scent, and not be a popular mainstream choice. Miss Dior is too sweet, and Santal 33 is over $200. Only Philosykos passes all the cutoffs.
5. Packaging: The overall design and the drawing feel like a piece of art, which fascinates her. However, she guesses that the name means love, but the package tells her nothing so she decides to ask a salesperson.
6. After trying it on her wrist, she ends up buying the perfume.

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Google Shopping search results for “Diptyque Philosykos,” screenshot taken October 26, 2026.

THANK YOU


L'AJOU
EN FLEUR
EAU
CAPITALE


SAPIN


POMANDER
VANILLE
CITROUILLE